THE SISTERHOOD

They spoke in tongues
My mother and her sisters.
All the Aunties
Gathered around the old oak kitchen table
Their spoons clanking against the sides of their teacups
Earnestly stirring in the sugar cubes.
(I was allowed but one.)
All the while chattering loudly and with gestures
And then looking around knowingly
Lapsing into their native German.
Those heavy, strange sounding words
Transforming their voices and their faces.
And I was left to wonder.
My mother said their talk was not for little ears.
But I knew it was a special, secret code
That would one day be passed to me.
And I believed they spoke in tongues
My mothers and her sisters.

2012